

# Offline benchmark compare

Toy engines teach mechanism; tables teach honesty

# Fair compare rules

- Identical input
- Fixed seeds when randomized
- Same metrics
- If an external tool is missing, document the gap, don't invent goldens

# What good looks like

- On this instance, several engines agree on cutsize three for the natural clusters
- Refinement shows twelve to three from a bad seed
- Huge unexplained wins usually mean a metric mismatch

# Your turn

- Fill the comparison table from EXAMPLES